SKILLNAVORA · AI PRODUCT MANAGEMENT & GENAI LAUNCHPAD

Product Operations

Help product teams scale: what product ops does, processes and rituals, tools and data, customer-insight pipelines, launch management, and AI in product ops.

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How to use this guide

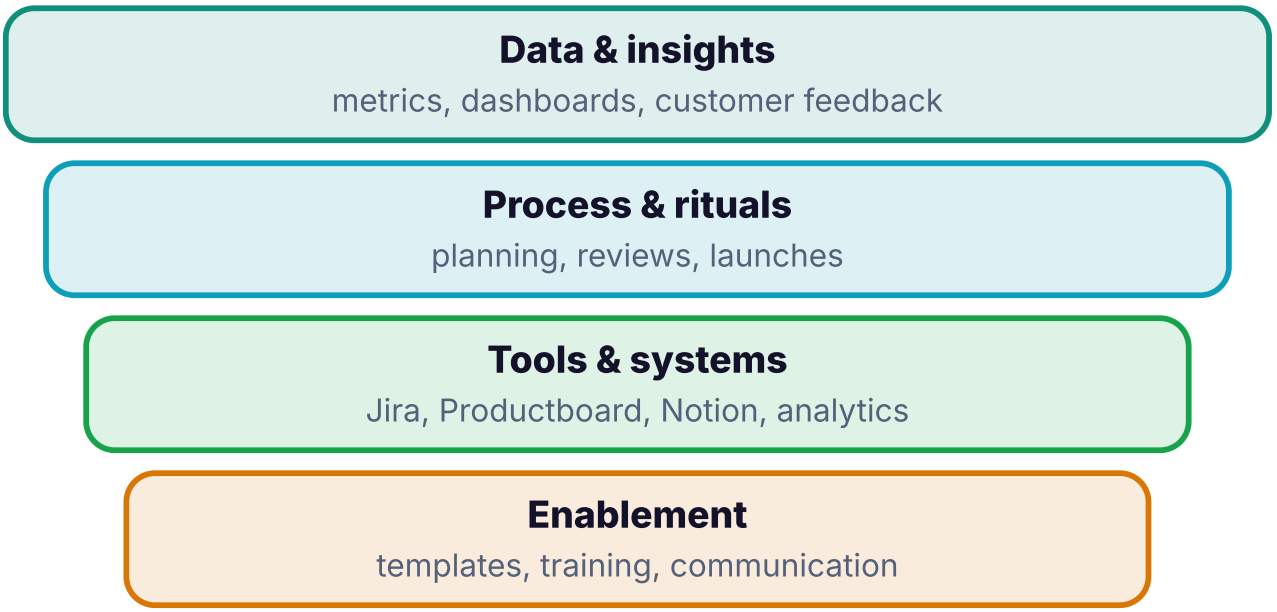
Each class has goals, concepts with Indian examples, key takeaways and a practice exercise, from basic to advanced. Finish with the final project to build something you can show in interviews.

	Class	Level
Class 1	**What product ops is**	Basic
Class 2	**Processes and rituals**	Basic
Class 3	**Tools and data**	Intermediate
Class 4	**Customer-insight pipelines**	Intermediate
Class 5	**Planning, OKRs and roadmap operations**	Intermediate
Class 6	**Data, analytics and experimentation operations**	Intermediate
Class 7	**Launch management and governance**	Advanced
Class 8	**Enablement, documentation and cross-functional operations**	Advanced
Class 9	**Measuring product ops and building the function**	Advanced
Class 10	**Case studies: three product ops improvements**	Advanced
Class 11	**Interview practice: product operations scenario questions**	Advanced
Class 12	**AI in product ops and final project**	Advanced
	Toolkit: templates, cheat sheet, glossary, 12 interview questions, further reading	

BASIC · CLASS 1

What product ops is

Know the scope and value of product ops.



Product ops pillars

Common in companies with 10+ PMs; in smaller teams PMs do it themselves.

What product ops does, by stage of company

Stage	Typical team	Focus
Startup (under 10 PMs)	PMs do it themselves; maybe one ops hire	Simple rituals, a single source of truth
Scale-up (10 to 50 PMs)	1 to 3 product ops	Planning cadence, tooling, launches, data
Enterprise (50+)	A product operations team	Governance, portfolio view, analytics, enablement, vendor management

Product ops is not a project manager, a PM's assistant or a bureaucracy team. It exists so product managers spend more time with customers and decisions and less on admin.

Key takeaways

- Product ops removes friction.
- Four pillars: data, process, tools, enablement.
- Scale matters.

Practice exercise: List 10 recurring admin tasks PMs on your team do.

BASIC · CLASS 2

Processes and rituals

Design lightweight rhythms.



Product operating rhythm

Each ritual needs an owner, inputs, outputs and a template; cut rituals that don't change decisions.

A sample quarterly rhythm

When	Ritual	Input	Output	Owner
Weeks -4 to -2	Quarterly planning	Strategy, metrics, customer insights	Priorities and OKRs	Head of product + product ops
Weekly	Product staff	Dashboard, blockers	Decisions and actions	Product lead
Every 2 weeks	Roadmap review	Delivery status, risks	Updated roadmap	PM + engineering lead
Monthly	Metrics review	KPI dashboard	Insights and experiments	Data + product ops
Per launch	Launch readiness	Checklist	Go / no-go	Launch lead
Quarterly	Retrospective	Outcomes vs plan	Learnings	Everyone

Kill test for a ritual: if skipping it for a month changes no decision, remove it or shorten it.

Key takeaways

- Rituals must change decisions.
- Templates make them fast.
- Owners keep them alive.

Practice exercise: Design the agenda and template for a monthly product review.

INTERMEDIATE · CLASS 3

Tools and data

Run the product tool stack and metrics.

- Single source of truth for roadmap and feedback (Productboard, Jira Product Discovery, Notion).
- Metrics definitions and dashboards (a metrics dictionary).
- Clean taxonomy: product areas, customer segments, tags.
- Tool consolidation and access hygiene.

A tool stack that works (examples)

Need	Examples	Tip
Roadmap and strategy	Productboard, Aha!, Jira Product Discovery, Notion	One roadmap, different views for execs and teams
Feedback and insights	Productboard, Dovetail, Enterpret, Airtable	Tag consistently; link feedback to opportunities
Analytics	Mixpanel, Amplitude, GA4, PostHog	Common event taxonomy and tracking plan
Experimentation	Optimizely, Statsig, GrowthBook, in-house	Central guardrails and a registry of tests
Docs and knowledge	Notion, Confluence, Google Docs	Templates and a single index
Delivery	Jira, Linear, Azure DevOps	Link tickets to goals and metrics

Tracking plan (a product ops staple)

A shared sheet listing every event: name, trigger, properties, owner, and the question it answers. Example: `checkout_started` (cart_value, items, device), used for the funnel from product page to payment. Without it, dashboards disagree and trust in data collapses.

Key takeaways

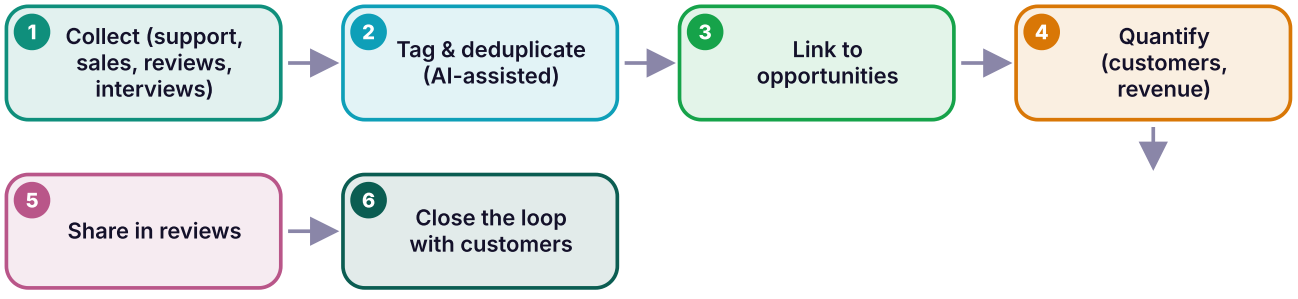
- One source of truth per object.
- A metrics dictionary prevents arguments.
- Taxonomy makes insights searchable.

Practice exercise: Draft a metrics dictionary with 8 metrics.

INTERMEDIATE · CLASS 4

Customer-insight pipelines

Turn feedback into prioritised insights.



Insight pipeline

A feedback taxonomy

Level	Example tags
Product area	Search, Checkout, Payments, Onboarding, Support
Type	Bug, usability, missing feature, pricing, performance, praise
Segment	SMB, enterprise, new user, power user, region
Severity / value	Blocker, major, minor; revenue at risk
Source	Support, sales call, NPS, review, interview, social

Report monthly: top 10 themes, trend, revenue linked, and what was done. Close the loop by telling customers when you ship what they asked for.

Key takeaways

- AI can tag and cluster feedback at scale.
- Link insights to opportunities and revenue.
- Close the loop with customers.

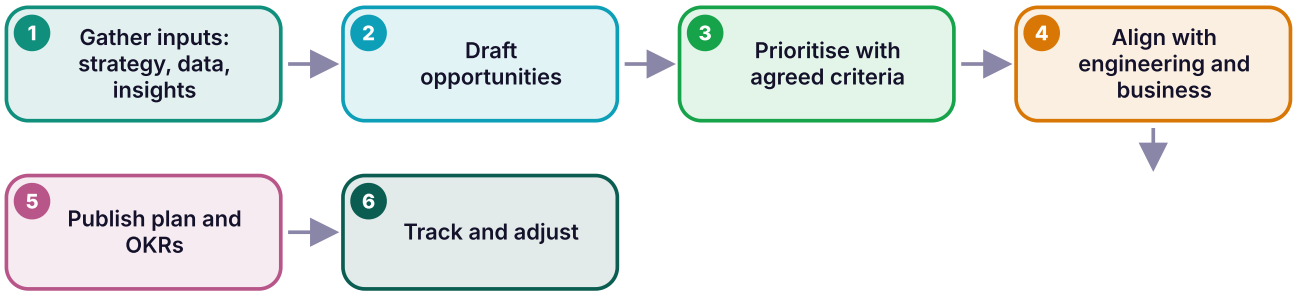
Practice exercise: Build a feedback-tagging taxonomy and test it on 30 items with AI.

INTERMEDIATE · CLASS 5

Planning, OKRs and roadmap operations

Run a planning process that people trust.

Product ops makes planning predictable: same inputs, same calendar, clear outputs.



A planning cycle

OKRs for product teams (example)

Objective	Key results
Make first purchase easier for new users	Increase first-order conversion from 22% to 28%; cut median checkout time from 95 s to 60 s; keep payment success at or above 97%
Reduce support load from order issues	Reduce 'where is my order' contacts per 100 orders from 6 to 4; launch proactive delay alerts to 100% of orders

Prioritisation criteria

Agree the criteria once: impact on the goal, reach, confidence, effort, strategic fit, risk. Use a simple score (RICE or weighted) as an input, never as an automatic decision.

Roadmap hygiene

- Roadmaps show **outcomes and themes** for the next 1 to 2 quarters, not dates for every feature.
- Keep three views: **exec** (themes and outcomes), **team** (epics and dependencies), **customer-facing** (what is coming, with no hard dates).
- Publish changes and the reason for them.

Key takeaways

- Same inputs, same calendar, clear outputs.
- OKRs: outcomes with measurable key results.
- Roadmaps show outcomes, not a feature-date list.

Practice exercise: Write one objective with three key results for your product and draft the exec and team roadmap views.

INTERMEDIATE · CLASS 6

Data, analytics and experimentation operations

Give product teams trustworthy numbers and a safe way to test.

The data foundation

- **Metrics dictionary:** one definition for each metric (active user, conversion, retention) with formula, source and owner.
- **Tracking plan and QA:** events defined before build and tested before release.
- **Dashboards:** a company KPI dashboard, a product-area dashboard for each team, and a launch dashboard template.
- **Self-serve access:** training so PMs can query basic questions without waiting for analysts.

Experiment operations

Step	Product ops role
Idea and hypothesis	Provide template: problem, change, metric, guardrails
Design	Check sample size, duration, segments, conflicts with other tests
Run	Monitor sample ratio mismatch and guardrails
Read-out	Standard report: effect, confidence interval, decision
Archive	Experiment registry so learnings are searchable

> Common failures: metrics defined differently by different teams, experiments that overlap, peeking at results early, and no record of past learnings.

Key takeaways

- A metrics dictionary prevents arguments.
- Plan events before building.
- Run experiments with templates, checks and an archive.

Practice exercise: Draft a metrics dictionary for five core metrics and a tracking plan for one flow.

ADVANCED · CLASS 7

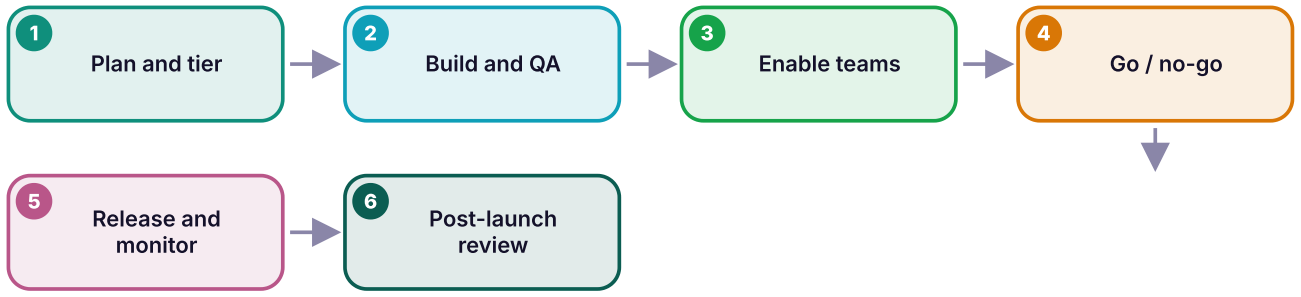
Launch management and governance

Make launches predictable.

- Launch tiers (big, medium, small) with checklists.
- Go/no-go reviews with evals, support readiness, docs, legal.
- Release notes and internal enablement; post-launch reviews.

Launch tiers and checklist

Tier	Example	Requirements
Tier 1 (major)	New product, pricing change, big redesign	Full plan: GTM, legal, support training, press, exec review, rollback plan
Tier 2 (medium)	Significant feature	Release notes, enablement, help articles, metrics dashboard
Tier 3 (small)	Minor improvement	Changelog entry, owner sign-off



The launch management flow

Key takeaways

- Tier launches by impact.
- Checklists and go/no-go.
- Post-launch review every time.

Practice exercise: Create a tiered launch checklist.

ADVANCED · CLASS 8

Enablement, documentation and cross-functional operations

Make sure sales, support and marketing can sell and support what is shipped.

- **Enablement kit per launch:** one-page summary, who it is for, demo video, FAQ, pricing and packaging rules, objection handling, known issues, escalation path.
- **Release notes and changelog:** customer-facing language; internal notes for support and sales.
- **Training:** short sessions plus recorded demos; test understanding with a quiz.
- **Documentation standards:** PRD template, decision log, product glossary, onboarding for new PMs.
- **Customer advisory boards and beta programs:** recruit, run, summarise and feed insights back.
- **Vendor and tool management:** licences, security reviews, renewals, adoption tracking.

Audience	Needs	Format
Sales	Why customers buy, pricing, competitors	Battlecard, demo, talk track
Customer support	How it works, known issues, escalation	Help article, internal FAQ, macros
Marketing	Positioning, proof points, launch assets	Messaging doc, case study
Executives	Outcome and risk	One-slide summary and dashboard

Key takeaways

- Enablement is part of the launch, not an afterthought.
- Write for each audience's decision.
- Keep documentation standards simple and searchable.

Practice exercise: Create an enablement kit outline for your next feature launch.

ADVANCED · CLASS 9

Measuring product ops and building the function

Show the value of product ops and grow it sensibly.

Metric	What it shows
Time from idea to decision	Planning efficiency
Launch readiness score and on-time rate	Launch quality
PM time on admin vs customers (survey)	Productivity
Data trust score (survey) and metric disputes	Data reliability
Feedback coverage and closed-loop rate	Customer voice
Experiment velocity and learning rate	Testing maturity
Stakeholder satisfaction	Alignment

Building a product ops function

1. **Diagnose:** interview PMs and partners; list top 10 pains.
2. **Start small:** pick 2 or 3 fixes (planning calendar, feedback taxonomy, launch checklist).
3. **Standardise lightly:** templates and tools, not heavy process.
4. **Automate:** reports, notes, tagging, status updates (with AI where safe).
5. **Report impact:** time saved, decisions sped up, quality improved.

Career and skills

Strong product ops professionals combine **process design, data fluency, communication, tools knowledge and influence without authority**. Paths include Product Ops Manager, Head of Product Operations, Product Manager, Chief of Staff or Program roles.

Key takeaways

- Measure decisions, speed and trust, not activity.
- Start with 2 to 3 high-value fixes.
- Product ops is influence plus systems.

Practice exercise: Define 5 metrics and a 90-day plan to start a product ops function.

ADVANCED · CLASS 10

Case studies: three product ops improvements

See how small systems fix big frictions (illustrative).

Case 1: Planning takes six weeks and nobody trusts the roadmap

- **Diagnosis:** different templates, inputs arrive late, priorities argued from scratch.
- **Actions:** a single planning calendar, one template, shared scoring criteria, a pre-read, and a decision log.
- **Result target:** planning in three weeks; roadmap changes explained in the log.

Case 2: Feedback is everywhere and unused

- Create one intake (form plus integrations), tag with the taxonomy, link to accounts and revenue, publish a monthly top-10 themes report and close the loop.
- Measure: share of shipped features linked to feedback, response time to customers.

Case 3: Launches surprise sales and support

- Introduce launch tiers, a checklist, an enablement kit and a go/no-go meeting; set a rule that no launch goes out without a support FAQ.
- Measure: support tickets in launch week, sales readiness score, post-launch review completion.

Key takeaways

- Diagnose the pain, then standardise lightly.
- Make feedback usable and traceable.
- Launch readiness protects customers.

Practice exercise: Pick a pain in your team and write the diagnosis, actions and measure.

ADVANCED · CLASS 11

Interview practice: product operations scenario questions

Answer product ops questions with practical detail.

Q. What would you do in your first 60 days as product ops manager?
Model answer: Interview PMs, designers, engineers and stakeholders; map current processes and tools; list the top 10 pains; pick two or three quick fixes (for example a planning calendar and feedback taxonomy); establish baseline metrics; and share a 90-day plan with owners.
Why it works: Listening, prioritising, measuring.

Q. How do you improve data trust?
Model answer: Create a metrics dictionary, a tracking plan with QA, a single source of truth for dashboards, ownership for each metric and a process for resolving disputes.
Why it works: Systems for data quality.

Q. PMs say process slows them. What do you do?
Model answer: Review each ritual's value; remove or shorten those that do not change decisions; automate reporting; keep templates simple; ask PMs to co-design changes.
Why it works: Empathy plus pruning.

Q. How do you measure the impact of product ops?
Model answer: Time to decision, launch readiness and incident rates, PM time on admin from surveys, data trust scores, feedback closure rate and stakeholder satisfaction.
Why it works: Outcome-focused metrics.

Key takeaways

- Start with diagnosis and quick fixes.
- Measure value, not activity.
- Co-design with PMs.

Practice exercise: Write your 60-day plan in one page.

ADVANCED · CLASS 12

AI in product ops and final project

Automate product ops with AI.

- AI skills for weekly reports, release notes, insight synthesis, meeting notes.
- Agents that keep Jira and docs in sync (with approvals).
- Dashboards with AI summaries.

Final project

Design a product-ops toolkit for a 10-PM team: operating rhythm, templates, metrics dictionary, insight pipeline, launch tiers, and 3 AI automations.

Key takeaways

- Automate reporting and synthesis.
- Keep humans on decisions.
- Measure time saved for PMs.

Practice exercise: Complete the product-ops toolkit.

TOOLKIT

Templates

Operating rhythm sheet

```
ritual | cadence | owner | inputs | outputs | template | decisions it informs
```

TOOLKIT

Cheat sheet

Term / tool	Meaning / use
Operating rhythm	Recurring planning and review cadence
Metrics dictionary	Agreed definitions of metrics
Launch tier	Size category deciding launch process
Rhythm	Weekly staff, bi-weekly roadmap, monthly metrics, quarterly planning
Launch tiers	T1 major, T2 medium, T3 small
Feedback taxonomy	Area, type, segment, severity, source

Glossary

Taxonomy	Agreed categories and tags
OKR	Objectives and Key Results
RICE	Reach, Impact, Confidence, Effort prioritisation score
Tracking plan	List of analytics events and properties
Metrics dictionary	Agreed definitions of metrics
Go / no-go	Launch decision meeting
Enablement	Materials that prepare sales, support and marketing
Battlecard	One-page guide to competing with a rival
Decision log	Record of decisions and reasons
Sample ratio mismatch	Experiment group sizes differ from plan, signalling a bug
Beta program	Early-access group for feedback
Closed loop	Telling customers what changed because of their feedback

INTERVIEW PREP

12 interview questions with answers

Q1. What is product ops?
A function that scales product teams through data, process, tools and enablement.

Q2. When do you need it?
When PM count grows and inconsistency, admin load and scattered data slow decisions.

Q3. How do you build an insight pipeline?
Collect from all channels, tag and dedupe (AI-assisted), link to opportunities, quantify, share, close the loop.

Q4. How does AI change product ops?
Automates synthesis, reports, release notes and tool hygiene; humans keep decisions.

Q5. What does a product operations team do?
It runs the systems around product work: planning, data and analytics, feedback, tooling, launches and enablement, so PMs can focus on customers and decisions.

Q6. How is product ops different from a program manager?
Program managers deliver specific cross-team programs. Product ops owns repeatable product systems and standards across the organisation.

Q7. How do you decide which ritual to remove?
Ask which decisions it changes. If skipping it changes no decision, shorten or remove it.

Q8. What is a tracking plan?
A shared definition of every analytics event, its trigger, properties and owner, so data is consistent and trusted.

Q9. How would you build a feedback pipeline?
Collect from support, sales, reviews and interviews, tag with a consistent taxonomy, link to opportunities and revenue, review monthly, and close the loop with customers.

Q10. How do you run a successful launch?
Tier the launch, set a checklist, enable sales and support, define metrics, run go/no-go, monitor, and hold a post-launch review.

Q11. How would you measure the success of product ops?
Time to decision, launch readiness, data trust, feedback loop closure, experiment velocity, and PM and stakeholder satisfaction.

Q12. How do you introduce process without creating bureaucracy?
Start with the biggest pains, keep templates light, involve PMs in design, measure value, and remove what does not help.

LEARN MORE

Further reading and tools

- Productboard: product ops: https://www.productboard.com/blog/
- Atlassian: Jira Product Discovery: https://www.atlassian.com/software/jira/product-discovery
- Mind the Product: product ops: https://www.mindtheproduct.com/
- Product Operations Handbook (Productboard): https://www.productboard.com/blog/
- Marty Cagan: SVPG articles: https://www.svpg.com/articles/
- Lenny's Newsletter: https://www.lennysnewsletter.com/

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